



A Your two best options for that price are the Nokia N81 and the Sony Ericsson K810i. The SE K810i has a slightly higher resolution camera as compared to the N81. You might need to purchase memory cards for the phones.

Need to purchase a new sound card

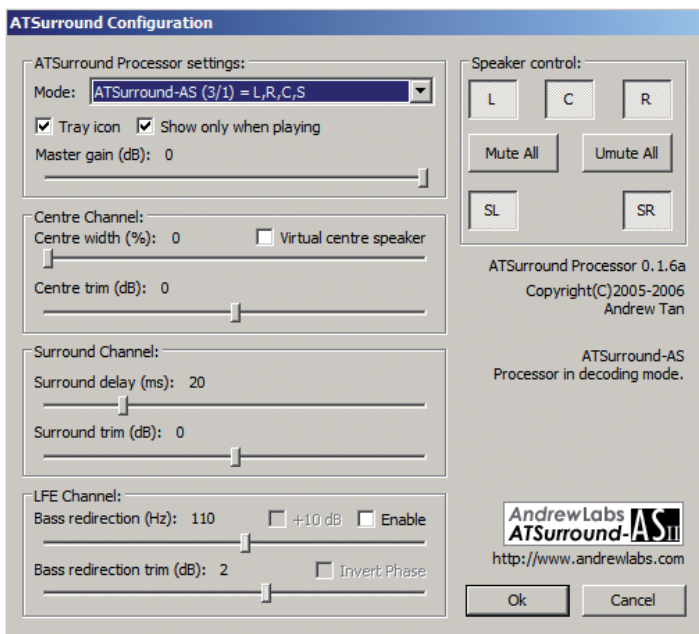
Q Hi,
I'm using PC with following configuration. An Intel Pentium 4 2.0 GHz, Intel 82845g motherboard, 1.25 GB DDR RAM, 80GB Samsung HDD, LG DVD writer and a CMI 8738 5.1 channel sound card. All this runs on Windows XP SP2. I want to upgrade my sound card. Please suggest to me which card would be good for my PC. I have TRUWAVE TW-1600(5.1ch) speakers.

So please tell me will it make any audible different by changing the sound card? My Budget is Rs 1000 to Rs 2,000. Are there any 5.1 channel plug-ins for Winamp?

Hitesh Joshi

A There are decent sound cards available between the price range you've stated. Whether you will be able to make out the difference or improvement with the speakers you own is a different question all together. The CMI 8738 was a good sound card for its price even then. You can consider the Audigy Value.

All the music we listen to is in stereo so by default they are meant for 2 speakers only. There are plugins which can replicate the sound to other channels. One of the more well known plugins for Winamp is ATSurround Processor (www.andrewlabs.com). More can be found in the plugin section on Winamp's site - www.winamp.com/plugins.



ATSurround Processor is a surround-sound plugin for Winamp and foobar2000

Is my pen drive dead?

Q I have a 2 GB pen drive. A virus from the Internet infected it and now when I used the pen drive on my PC, it too got infected by the same virus. I formatted my computer to remove the virus from the particular drive. While formatting the PC, my pen drive was also connected to my PC. I also formatted my pen drive using FAT 32 to remove the virus it. After formatting it, my pen drive is not working anymore. If I try to format, it shows an error that Window cannot perform this operation.

If I want to send something in it says "Please insert a disk in the drive". It is neither showing the name of pen drive nor the capacity of it nor the partition type means either it is NTFS/ FAT type please.

Do I have to buy a new pan drive? The warranty for the pen drive has expired. Please reply me.

A First of all download Kaspersky Antivirus 2009 from <http://www.kaspersky.com/anti-virus/trial>

Activate it as a trial version and update it from the internet. Run a full system scan on your computer. Connect your pen drive to your computer. Then right click on My Computer and click on Manage. A window will appear which is called Computer Management. Now click on Storage on the left hand side pane and then click on Disk Management.

Here you will be able to see your pen drive as a removal drive. Try formatting it by right clicking on it and clicking on format. Format it using FAT32 partition type. If you face any problem while doing it, means that your pen drive is no more working and there is no solution to it.

Aditya (TECH QNA Expert)

RAR Files Giving CRC Errors

Q I have the following PC configuration. An Intel C2D E7200, Intel original DG33FB motherboard, 4 GB RAM 667 MHz, Seagate Barracuda 400 GB SATA HDD, XFX Nvidia GeForce 9600GT video card and an LG 20x DVD writer. The problem is whenever I try to extract any huge RAR file I get CRC errors and extraction fails. But when the same file is extracted on other computer the extraction is successful without any errors. Please help me I am fed up of this.

CRC errors can occur due to many different types of problems. Some of these problems are:

1. Damage to file during the copying process.
2. Problems with the device that is accessing or opening the file.
3. Problems with the file itself.

A Try re-downloading the file or transfer it from some other source, other than the one you are using currently. Try using some other compression software other than

WinRAR. There are many good ones available. WinRAR has a repair mode. Accessible through [Ctrl] + [R] or the link is there on the task menu of WinRAR. Try it.

Ramik Sadana (TECH QNA Expert)

Hard Drive Issues

Q I purchased a new WD hard disk of 80 GB, at the time of partition the system shutdown due to overheating issues but after that there weren't any more error message. I installed the Windows XP SP3 but now I am facing a problem of sudden restarts which are almost at the same time interval but after three or four restarts the system becomes stable. Help me out.

A You must check your processor first and make sure that it does not overheat again. Also check your hard disk for any bad sectors through chkdsk / scandisk. Also if possible take the data backup, repartition it and then do a standard format for each partition.

Sanjeev Chharia (TECH QNA Expert)

My Documents Popup

Q When I open my computer, "My Documents" opens up automatically.

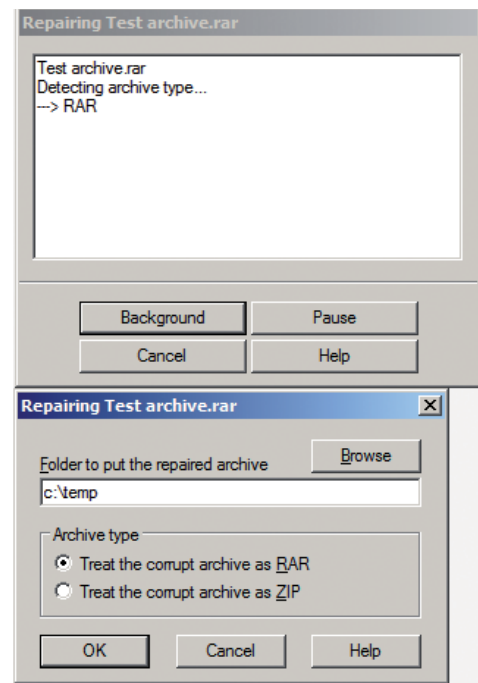
A If I understand you right - after your PC boots up your My Documents folder is opened on your desktop.

If that is correct, I think you should check your Startup folder in the Start > All Programs menu. Make sure a link to your My Documents folder is not listed in there.

If so just right click on it and select Delete. Also try this, check the Userinit and PersistBrowsers registry entries to make sure that they contain the correct values.

To check the Userinit and PersistBrowsers registry entries, follow these steps.

- a. Click Start, click Run, type regedit in the Open box, and then click OK.
- b. Locate and then click the following registry subkey: HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SOFTWARE\Microsoft\Windows NT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon
- c. In the right pane, right-click Userinit, and then click Modify.
- d. In the Edit String dialog box, type C:\WINDOWS\system32\userinit.exe under Value data, and then click OK.
- e. Locate and then click the



WinRAR has a archive repairing feature for files that are corrupt

following registry subkey: HCU\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced f. in the right pane, right-click PersistBrowsers, and then click Modify. g. In the Edit DWORD Value dialog box, type 0 under Value data, and then click OK. h. Quit Registry Editor, and restart the computer.

Jagdeep Virdi (TECH QNA Expert)

Removing Windows Vista From The Boot Selection Menu

Q I have Windows XP on my desktop PC. One day I installed Windows Vista on another partition. But after 30 days it stopped booting. So I formatted my Vista but every time I try to boot, it asks me for which OS I want to boot from that the OS selection menu. Now, I am working with only Windows XP. How can I erase the entry from the boot menu? I have been trying to edit the boot.ini file but there is no line of selecting option. Please help me.

Purnia

A Although you have erase Windows Vista from you hard drive and install a fresh Windows XP as a replacement, Vista boot loader will still remain on your system. This is quite annoying because you see it at every bootup.

There are two ways we can do to erase Windows Vista bootloader, the first one:

1. Boot to Windows XP. Put your Vista DVD to your DVD-Rom
2. Click on Start > Run, and type x:\boot\bootsect.exe /nt52 All /force Note: "x" is your DVD-Rom drive name.

- Or you can try the second steps:
1. Boot you PC using Windows XP SP2 CD.
 2. Run the Recovery Console.
 3. When the console is loaded, type "fixboot" (without quotes) and press Enter.
 4. Then, type fixmbr and press Enter.
 5. Reboot your PC to see the results.

Jagdeep Virdi (TECH QNA Expert)

Need Wireless Internet

Q How can I setup a wireless Internet connection? I'm now using BSNL Broadband connection with desktop PC, but I want to setup this connection with my Laptop. How can I set up Internet connection using mobile (using Blue Tooth and Data cable) with the laptop.

Koushik

A You just need a WiFi router, which costs around Rs 2,000. Connect the desktop using wires and laptop wirelessly and enjoy!

If your phone has WiFi, you can browse too. Bluetooth is possible too but is too slow and doesn't have a very wide range.

Gopi (TECH QNA Expert)

